

NYU STERN

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT NYU STERN

Much like New York City itself, NYU Stern has changed significantly over the years. Though the Columbia Business School may disagree, Stern is the business school of Wall Street, and was even located near Wall Street until the early nineties. The main campus is in Greenwich Village, with the second highest concentration of Internet startups in the U.S. after Silicon Valley. Featuring a dual-degree program with the Tisch School of the Arts, the school is also a center for artistic creation, and it is no surprise that the school has such strong ties with the fashion industry, luxury brands, and the world of entertainment and media.

With faculty that include Professor of Economics Nouriel Roubini, who anticipated the collapse of the U.S. housing market and worldwide recession, Stern's influence extends from Wall Street to Main Street. The school has some of the best finance professors in the world, and a constant stream of influential guest speakers.

Over the past few years, NYU Stern has been doubling down on tech. In addition to the introduction of the Tech MBA in 2018, Stern has added several tech-specific specializations to its already packed roster, including Business Analytics, FinTech, and Product Management.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

*Finance, Accounting, Entertainment Media, Product Management,
Luxury & Retail, Marketing, Real Estate, Strategy, Business Analytics,
Entrepreneurship & Innovation*

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	16	-	22	24	17	18	13	13
Financial Times	10	12	10	10	10	11	13	13
Forbes	-	23	-	18	-	21	-	20
The Economist	9	6	6	9	14	14	15	14
US News	11	10	10	11	20	12	13	12

CLASS OF 2021 ADMISSIONS

Number of Applicants	3518	Avg Age	28
MBA Class Size	350	Avg GMAT	721
Admissions selectivity	26%	Avg GPA	3.52
Yield	38%	% International	33%
Total Tuition	148,368	% Women	37%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2019)

Consulting	37%
Finance	30%
Technology	15%
Consumer / Retail	5%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Deloitte, McKinsey, BCG, EY, Amazon, Bain, JP Morgan, PwC, BAML, Credit Suisse, Goldman Sachs, Citi, Google, Kearney, American Express, Evercore, Houlihan Lokey, Pfizer, Strategy&

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$135,299

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 95%

*Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR NYU STERN APPLICATION

BY TRISHA NUSSBAUM

Trisha is an NYU Stern alumna with experience working at top tech giants Google and IBM. As Vice President of NYU Stern's Technology Association, she worked with both current and aspiring MBAs to elevate their resumes and interviewing prowess. Additionally, she was a Graduate Teaching Fellow for Technology Product Management, working directly with Stern's first class of Tech-focused MBAs to develop ideas into goals and actions. While at Google, she was involved in intern selection and program management.



Stern is proud of its reputation for developing students who are not only smart but also have interpersonal strengths and teamwork skills.

1

EQ + IQ

Stern is proud of its reputation for developing students who are not only smart but also have interpersonal strengths and teamwork skills. The Admissions Committee uses a holistic approach to evaluate applicants, looking beyond strong grades and test scores. Stern will evaluate individuals' personal characteristics and is looking for prospective students who will be involved in the school community.

You will have a number of opportunities to demonstrate your EQ and IQ, through your essays, interview and campus visit, as well as the EQ endorsement. They are looking for a richer and deeper understanding of who you are through this endorsement, so you should choose someone who knows you extremely well and can be a powerful and compelling advocate of your EQ. Resist the inclination to get hung up the person's title or position. This is about who knows you best and who can communicate your strengths most strongly.

STRENGTHS BEYOND FINANCE

2

As a top-ranked business school in NYC, it's no surprise that Stern is world-renowned for its strength in finance, but it is also strong in a number of other disciplines. Don't be concerned if you have never taken a finance class or if you work in an unrelated industry. The Stern Admissions Committee values diversity and looks for candidates from many different backgrounds, as well as students who appreciate diversity. Be sure to explore the different specializations and be prepared to communicate them during your interview, painting a picture of how your experience will be enhanced with the offerings

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CHANGE. DARE IT. DREAM IT. DRIVE IT.

In 2019, Stern released a 'call to action,' rebranding with its new slogan "Change. Dare it. Dream it. Drive it." Just as Stern has taken many steps to enhance its program towards a rapidly changing, forward-thinking world, such as adding tech-oriented options, the Admissions Committee wants to see an analogous motivation in its applicants. Through its experiential learning offerings, the school is focused on immersing creative individuals in the fast-paced business epicenter of New York City. Specifically, Endless Frontier Labs and Brand Consulting Lab are just two examples where Stern partners students directly with companies, recently Spotify, to create new messaging, features and products. Stern has introduced a new curriculum organized around this slogan to reinforce each of these action items. Think about how this ethos and new curriculum will play into your Professional Aspirations essay.

A COMMUNITY OF STERNIES

4

From the moment you set foot on campus, you'll witness firsthand how the Stern students and faculty are approachable and collaborative. This sense of community is often noted by students and alumni in testimonials. Sternies are ingrained with a sense a responsibility to help each other throughout their MBA, constantly developing new resources for knowledge sharing and interpersonal development.

A big part of the Stern experience involves extracurricular activities, which include professional groups as well as recreational clubs. MBA students run the campus clubs and select the next generation of leaders in each incoming class.

Whether you have a talent in music or sports or just have a desire to learn something new, the committee is interested in hearing what you can contribute to the Stern community.

5

ADDRESSING WEAKNESSES IN YOUR APPLICATION

Take a look at Stern's latest class profile - if you fall below the middle 80% range in GMAT or undergraduate GPA you can take steps to address your concerns. For someone with a limited number of quantitative classes on your resume or poor undergraduate grades, consider taking a class like calculus, statistics, economics, or even accounting to prove you can handle the quant-heavy coursework. You can also think about taking on analytical projects at your job to show your strength in this area. In addition to considering a candidate's academic and professional background in the admissions process, Stern places a strong emphasis on personal characteristics. If you are weaker in one area, find a way to show strengths in another.

ESSAY ANALYSIS

In addition to considering a candidate's academic and professional background in the admissions process, Stern places a strong emphasis on personal characteristics and is looking for students who will be involved in the school and community.



ESSAY 1. Professional Aspirations

(500 word maximum, double-spaced, 12-point font)

- **What are your short and long-term career goals?**
- **How will the MBA help you achieve them?**

The admissions committee at Stern is looking for a clear plan from its applicants that coherently aligns with your past experiences. Even if your ambitions evolve along the way – the MBA should be a transformative experience after all – the Admissions Committee wants confidence you can envision how the Stern MBA will add value to your career goals. Your ability to articulate a coherent, compelling career vision is an indication of the quality of work – and clarity of thought – you’re capable of producing. Create a path that makes sense given your academic and professional background, and the transferrable skills that you’ll bring with you to the next steps in your career. You need to convey, either as a career enhancer or a career switcher, that the path is viable.

It is helpful to begin with a brief anecdote from your background, or a consistent passion in your life, that sets up a path towards your goals. Next, spend a paragraph on how your experiences have led you towards your short-term goals, directly stating what they are. It’s important that your short-term goals are well thought-out, whereas your long-term goals can be more general, with an explanation of how an MBA from Stern will help you on this path. Lastly, explain Stern’s part in achieving your goals, focusing on the unique qualities of the school, such as experiential learning and its location. You can demonstrate your dedication to the Stern community by explaining how you plan to get involved in clubs and activities.

ESSAY 2. Personal Expression (a.k.a. "Pick Six")

Describe yourself to the Admissions Committee and to your future classmates using six images and corresponding captions. Your uploaded PDF should contain all of the following elements:

- **A brief introduction or overview of your "Pick Six" (no more than 3 sentences).**
- **Six images that help illustrate who you are.**
- **A one-sentence caption for each of the six images that helps explain why they were selected and are significant to you.**

Note: Your visuals may include photos, infographics, drawings, or any other images that best describe you. Your document must be uploaded as a single PDF. The essay cannot be sent in physical form or be linked to a website.

If essay 1 delivers an understanding of your professional goals and academic achievements – what you do – essay 2 is about who you are. In addition to considering a candidate's academic and professional background in the admissions process, Stern places a strong emphasis on personal characteristics and is looking for students who will be involved in the school and community. The Pick Six is a place to let your personality shine. Given that you have only six images and associated captions, what is the story you wish to tell? Are you a marathon runner, toastmaster or volunteer firefighter? Do you have strong ties with your

family, a cause or friends from different walks of life? These are all great themes to communicate visually in your pick six.

The pick six also helps the Admissions Committee gauge your 'fit' with the program and community, and ensures that you have the qualities of a "Sternie." This is a prime opportunity to showcase your EQ by representing the key inspirations that drive you to have a positive impact on those around you. Know that Stern values individuality, so think about the range of images that can offer more insight into who you are.

Finally, while the openness of the instructions may suggest the committee is looking for an artistic presentation, there is no need to overthink it. What's most important are the images you select and the captions, so long as the final PDF is organized and refined.

DEADLINES & DATES*

FULL-TIME MBA DEADLINE

1st Deadline	15 October 2020
2nd Deadline	15 November 2020
3rd Deadline	15 January 2021
4th Deadline	15 March 2021

FASHION & LUXURY, AND TECH MBA DEADLINES

1st Deadline	15 October 2020
2nd Deadline	15 November 2020
3rd Deadline	15 January 2021
4th Deadline	15 February 2021



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

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